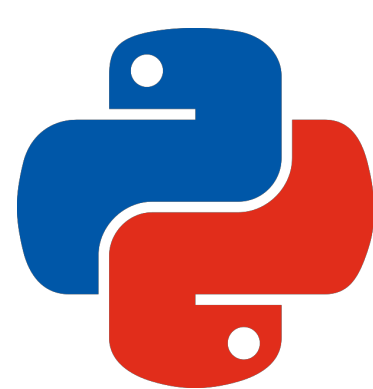




PySchool - Introducing highschool students to Python



TLDR; We motivated highschoolers to learn Python, using a simple website powered by quarto+pyodide. They loved it!

MOTIVATION

Previous events organized by Python Chile (PyDay and PyCon) aimed "grownups". We realized we needed an event targetting highschool students. Although we can't teach Python in a day, we can show how simple and fun coding in Python can be, and motivate students to start learning Python!



PySchool 2024's class:
We tested 2 room setups and learned that a more relaxed and interactive class lead to better learning and was preferred by students. Highschoolers liked the event (average evaluation of 9.3/10) but suggested some improvements over the content and delivery.

PAST

Setup

quarto+pyodide allowed us to code a simple website in Spanish (pyschool.cl) that does not requires users to install Python!
It's simpler to use than jupyter notebooks.
It does not require an account and students can use the website any time, after PySchool.

PySchool 2024

Intro to Python (1h) and Intro to Data Analysis (1h).
≈100 students & 3 dates in Valparaíso, Chile.

PRESENT

Learning from the feedback

Traditional classes are boring! Standard lab setup does not allow for easy interaction!
Challenges and discussion keeps students engaged.

Improving content

We rebuilt the site as an "escape room" where Python puzzles need to be solved to advance to next room.

Pyschool 2025

We will be testing this new approach on the second half of 2025.

FUTURE

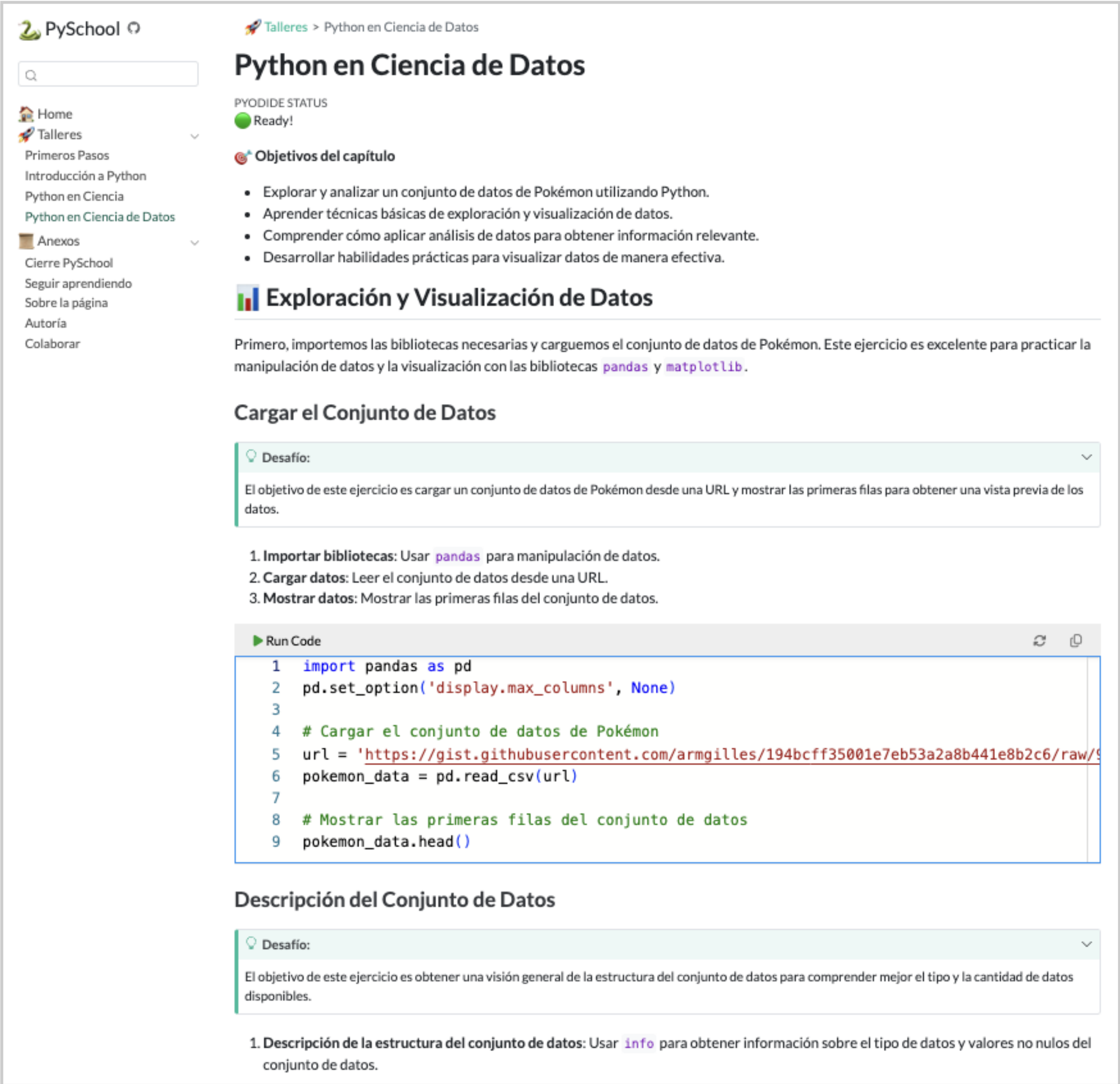
Make it scalable

For this project to grow, we need a "train the trainers" approach: make it easily replicable by anyone interested, without needing us to provide support.

Translate to other languages

English? French? Italian?
Licence is MIT - feel free what it's valuable to you and translate it, replicate, mix, whatever.

Volunteer if you want to help!



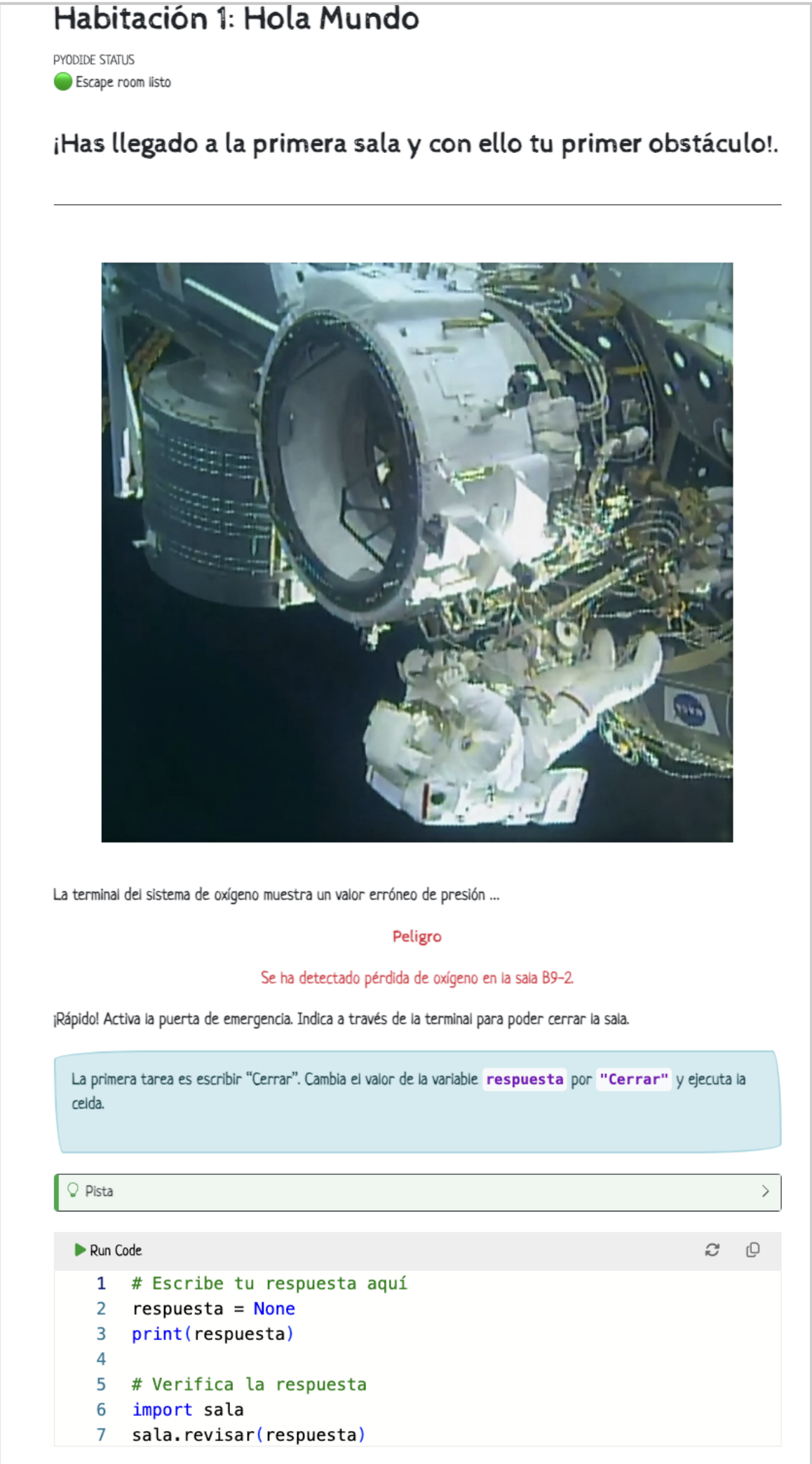
Left image: PySchool 2024's website

The previous version of the website allowed to validate the tech stack: using quarto+pyodide was simple to develop and easy to use by students.



Right image: PySchool 2025's website

The new versio of the website has a "escape room setup", where each room is a challenge to be solved, focused on one key aspect of Python (strings, floats, lists, dicts, etc). Brief explanations of each concept are provided, when needed.



Share: Let others know about PySchool!

Give us Feedback: Let us know what might improve PySchool!

Try it: Quarto + Pyodide can help you create interactive websites.
Attendees won't need to install Python on workshops, talks or documentation!

Network and Learn: We're excited to meet other Python enthusiasts and educators to talk about teaching Python, learning methods, and new technologies.

Website: Francisco Alfaro, Sebastián Flores & Tony Rodríguez

Coordination: Marcelo Figueroa, Patricia Tapia, Cristina Verdugo & Darwin Morales.

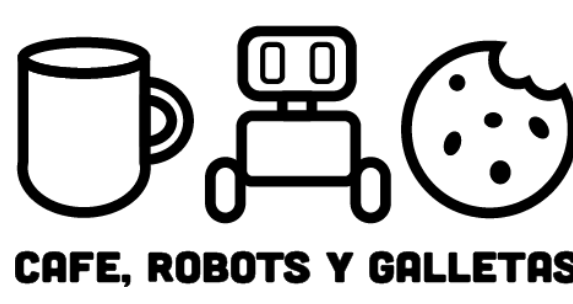
Volunteers: Yialenne Alviña, Valeska Canales, Liliana Garmendia, Bastián Landskron, Cristián López & María Fernanda Villalobos

Poster: Sebastián Flores

HELP US!

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS



LINKS